

UVW

UGNI

MYRTACEAE

Genus of densely leafy, evergreen shrubs or trees. *U. molinae*, the only species usually cultivated, is valued for its foliage, flowers, and fruit. Frost hardy to frost tender. Needs full sun or partial shade and moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in late summer. ***U. molinae***, syn. *Eugenia ugni*, *Myrtus ugni*. Evergreen, upright, densely branched shrub. H 5ft (1.5m), S 3ft (1m). Glossy, dark green leaves are ovate. Bears fragrant, slightly nodding, cup-shaped, white-pink-tinted flowers in late spring, then aromatic, edible, spherical, dark red fruits. Good for hedging in mild areas. Z7–11. **‘Flambeau’** has dark gray-green leaves margined creamy white and flushed pink when young.

ULEX

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of leafless, or almost leafless, shrubs that appear evergreen as a result of their year-round, green shoots and spines. Grown for its flowers in spring. Fully to frost hardy. Needs full sun, and prefers poor, well-drained, acidic soil. Trim each year after flowering to maintain compact habit. Straggly, old plants may be cut back hard in spring. Propagate by seed in fall. ☉ The seeds may cause mild stomach upset if ingested. ***U. europaeus*** (Gorse) illus. p.148. **‘Flore Pleno’** is a leafless, or almost leafless, bushy shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 4ft (1.2m). In spring, bears profuse, fragrant, pealike, double, yellow flowers on leafless, dark green shoots. Z5–9

ULMUS

Elm

ULMACEAE

Genus of deciduous or, rarely, semi-evergreen trees and, very rarely, shrubs, often large and stately, grown for their foliage and habit. Inconspicuous flowers are borne in spring. Fully to frost hardy. Requires full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed or suckers in fall. Susceptible to Dutch elm disease, which is quickly fatal, although *U. parvifolia* and *U. pumila* appear more resistant than other species and hybrids. ***U. americana*** (American white elm, White elm). Deciduous, spreading tree. H and S 100ft (30m). Has gray bark and drooping branchlets. Large, ovate, dark green leaves are sharply toothed and rough-textured. Z2–9 ***U. ‘Camperdownii’***. See *U. glabra* **‘Camperdownii’**. ***U. carpinifolia***. See *U. minor*. ***U. glabra*** (Wych elm). Deciduous, spreading tree. H 35–40m (120–130ft), S 80ft (25m). Has broadly ovate, toothed, very rough, dark green leaves, often slightly lobed at tips. Tiny red flowers in

early spring are followed by clusters of winged, green fruits on bare branches. Z5–7. **‘Camperdownii’** (syn. *U. ‘Camperdownii’*) illus. p.88. **‘Exoniensis’** (Exeter elm), H 50ft (15m), S 15ft (5m), is narrow with upright branches when young, later becoming more spreading. ***U. x hollandica*** (Dutch elm). Vigorous, deciduous tree with a short trunk and spreading to arching branches. H 100ft (30m), S 80ft (25m). Has ovate, toothed, glossy, dark green leaves. Very susceptible to Dutch elm disease. Tiny red flowers in early spring are followed by winged, green fruit. Z5–9. **‘Dampieri Aurea’**, H 20–25ft (6–8m), S 10–12ft (3–4m), is relatively slow-growing, with bright golden yellow leaves. Appears to be resistant to Dutch elm disease. **‘Jacqueline Hillier’**, H and S 8ft (2.5m), is slow-growing and suitable for hedging. Small leaves, rough-textured and sharply toothed, form 2 rows on each shoot; they persist into early winter. **‘Vegeta’** see *U. x vegeta*.

U. minor, syn. *U. carpinifolia* (Smooth-leaved elm). Deciduous, spreading tree with arching branches and pendent shoots. H 100ft (30m), S 70ft (20m). Small, ovate, toothed, glossy, bright green leaves turn yellow in fall. Tiny red flowers in early and mid-spring are followed by green, winged fruit. Z5–9

U. parvifolia (Chinese elm). Deciduous or semievergreen, rounded tree with pendent shoots and flaking bark, marked orange and brown. H 60ft (18m), S 25–40ft (8–12m). Small, ovate, glossy, dark green leaves last well into winter or, in mild areas, may persist until fresh growth develops. Tiny red flowers in late summer to fall are followed by winged, green fruit. Z4–9

U. procera (English elm). Vigorous, deciduous, spreading tree with a dense, dome-shaped head. H 130ft (40m), S 50ft (15m). Broadly ovate, toothed, rough, dark green leaves turn yellow in fall. Tiny red flowers in early spring are followed by winged, green fruit. Z5–9

U. pumila (Siberian elm). Deciduous, spreading, sometimes shrubby tree. H 70–100ft (20–30m), S 40ft (12m). Produces ovate, toothed, dark green leaves. Tiny red flowers in early spring are followed by winged, green fruit. Has some resistance to Dutch elm disease, but seedlings may be susceptible in hot summers. Z4–9

U. x vegeta, syn. *U. x hollandica* **‘Vegeta’** (Huntingdon elm). Fast-growing deciduous tree. H 120ft (35m), S 80ft (25m). Has upright central branches and pendent outer shoots. Broadly ovate leaves turn yellow in fall. Z5–9

UMBELLULARIA

Headache tree

LAURACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen, spring-flowering tree, grown for its aromatic foliage, although the scent of the crushed leaves may induce headaches and nausea in some people. Fully hardy, but shelter from strong, cold winds when young. Requires sun and fertile, moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall. ***U. californica*** (Californian laurel) illus. p.69.

UMBILICUS

CRASSULACEAE

Genus of deciduous perennials with underground tubers and unusual, shield-shaped, succulent leaves, and one evergreen, perennial, creeping succulent with opposite leaves. Grown for their foliage and spikes or sprays of small flowers. Fully to frost hardy. Perennials require shade or partial shade and moist soil; *U. oppositifolius* requires sun or partial shade and moisture-retentive but free-draining soil. Best grown in a rock garden wall or crevice. Propagate from seed, offsets or cuttings. *U. oppositifolius* is susceptible to vine weevil.

U. oppositifolius, syn. *Chiastophyllum oppositifolium*, *Cotyledon simplicifolia* of gardens, illus. p.335. **‘Jim’s Pride’** is a creeping, evergreen perennial. H 6–8in (15–20cm), S 6in (15cm). Has large, oblong, serrated, succulent, dark green leaves, edged with creamy-yellow. Bears tiny yellow flowers in arching sprays in late spring and early summer. Z4–8

Urceolina peruviana. See

Stenomesson miniatum.

Urginea maritima. See *Drimia maritima*.

URSINIA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals and evergreen perennials and subshrubs, grown mainly for their flower heads usually in summer, a few species for their foliage. Frost hardy to frost tender. Needs full light and well-drained soil. Water potted plants sparingly when not in full growth. Requires good ventilation when grown under glass. Propagate by seed or by greenwood cuttings in spring. Aphids can sometimes be troublesome.

U. anthemoides illus. p.322.

U. chrysanthemoides. Evergreen, bushy perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm) or more. Narrowly ovate, feathery, strongly scented, green leaves are 2in (5cm) long. Bears small, long-stalked, daisylike, yellow flower heads, sometimes coppery below, in summer. Z10–12 (min. 41–45°F/5–7°C) ***U. sericea***. Evergreen, bushy subshrub. H and S to 28in (70cm). Leaves are cut into an elegant filigree of very slender, silver-haired segments. Bears daisylike, yellow flower heads, ½in (4cm) across, in summer. Mainly grown for its foliage. Z10–12 (min. 41–45°F/5–7°C)

UTRICULARIA

LENTIBULARIACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen, annual and perennial, carnivorous water plants with bladderlike, modified leaves that trap and digest insects. Most species in cultivation are free-floating. Fully hardy to frost tender. Some species are suitable only for tropical aquariums; those grown in outdoor pools require full sun. Thin out plants that are overcrowded or are laden with algae. Propagate by division of floating foliage in spring or summer.

U. bisquamata ‘Betty’s Bay’. Small, terrestrial annual. H 6in (15cm), S 8in

(20cm). Has tiny, linear leaves. From early summer to fall, bears large, pale yellow and lilac flowers. It produces no seed, so is not invasive. Z10–11

U. sandersonii. Deciduous perennial. H and S 4–20in (10–50cm). In summer, bears white or pale pink flowers, with a lavender-colored marking on the upper lip and base of the lower lip. Z10–11

UVULARIA

COLCHICACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering rhizomatous perennials that thrive in moist woodlands. Fully hardy. Requires partial shade and prefers moist but well-drained, peaty soil. Propagate by division in early spring, before flowering.

U. grandiflora (Bellwort, Merry-bells) illus. p.262.

U. perfoliata. Clump-forming perennial. H to 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). In spring, produces clusters of pendent, bell-shaped, pale yellow flowers with twisted petals on numerous slender stems, above stem-clasping, narrowly ovate, mid-green leaves. Z4–9

VACCINIUM

ERICACEAE

Genus of deciduous, semievergreen or evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their foliage, fall color (on deciduous species), flowers and fruits, which are often edible. Fully to frost hardy. Needs sun or partial shade and moist but well-drained, peaty or sandy, acidic soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.

V. angustifolium var. laevifolium (Low-bush blueberry) illus. p.163.

V. arctostaphylos (Caucasian whortleberry). Deciduous, upright shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 6ft (2m). Has red-brown young shoots and ovate, dark green leaves that mature to red and purple in fall. Bell-shaped, white flowers, tinged with red, are produced in spreading racemes in early summer, followed by spherical, purplish-black fruits. Z5–9

V. corymbosum (Highbush blueberry) illus. p.150. **‘Duke’** is an upright, deciduous shrub. H 5½ft (1.6m), S 5ft (1.5m). Has mid-green leaves that turn orange in fall. White late spring flowers are followed by medium-sized, edible, blue-black fruits. **‘Pioneer’** illus. p.163. **‘Spartan’**, H to 6ft (1.8m), S 5ft (1.5m), has large, sweet fruit. Z5–7

V. glaucoalbum illus. p.165. ***V. myrtillus*** (Bilberry, Whortleberry). Deciduous, usually prostrate shrub.

H to 1ft (30cm), S indefinite. Bears small, heart-shaped, leathery, bright green leaves. Pendent, bell-shaped, pale pink flowers in early summer are followed by edible, round, blue-black fruits. Z3–8 ***V. nummularia***. Evergreen, prostrate shrub. H to 1ft (30cm), S to 2ft (60cm). Slender stems, covered in red-brown bristles, bear ovate, wrinkled, bright green leaves with red-brown bristles at their margins. Small racemes of bell-shaped, white to deep pink flowers at stem tips in early summer are followed